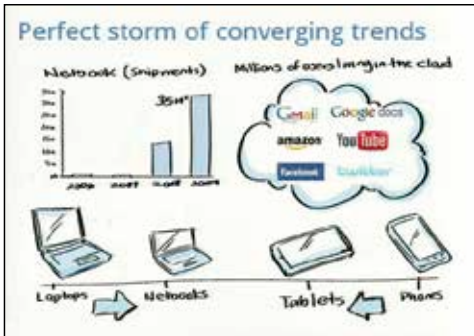


at a fraction of the original resources. This further blurs the line between traditional software and web applications.

Of course, an operating system also serves many other functions but all of those are only facilitators of the actions that the user wishes to perform. And if all those actions can be accomplished via the browser interface in an



effective and functional manner, it is clear that the benefits will outweigh the costs. The benefits themselves are extraordinary and we shall cover them in detail later on but what we lose is of equal importance.

The ability to tweak the operating system is completely taken out of the user's hands in Chrome OS. Since the system in its ideal state is designed from the firmware upwards, it can't be easily changed without risks to the overall system. And unlike updates in traditional operating systems, Chrome OS is upgraded compulsorily on a regular basis with no choice in the hands of the consumer. Since its release Chrome OS has already reached version 23 by 2014 and will continue to be upgraded with no option to rollback.

For many users, this form of computing may prove highly likeable since Chrome OS serves a broad and general user base such as kids, educational organisations, enterprise companies, governmental organisations and web-app developers. The lack of high end gaming and powerful graphic editing capabilities make it of no interest to professionals who require high resource softwares to perform their jobs. But it's very likely that as upgrades continue, internet bandwidth improves and new development takes place in language porting, we shall find web applications advanced enough to tackle all high resource intensive tasks on the cloud.

How Do Chrome OS and Chromium OS Differ?

Both the Chrome OS and Chromium OS are close cousins of the same family. The Chromium OS is actually an open sourced project that is favoured by developers with a code that can be customised and modified